

The Roadman Method — Login Debug Log

Prepared 11 May 2026 at 12:49 for the editor

Summary

The `/method/login` page on `roadmancycling.com` was inaccessible due to a series of cascading issues: a missing environment variable, a burned magic-link token during a mid-deploy transition, and finally a redirect loop caused by incorrect middleware header injection. The root cause was that the layout's pathname detection always defaulted to `"/method"`, causing authenticated requests on any deeper path (e.g. `/method/dashboard`) to redirect to themselves infinitely.

Timeline

Time (UTC)	Event	Outcome
11 May ~10:00	Method course pages deployed (commits <code>b56a0d0d</code> → <code>d5a8d25b</code>)	Pages live, no auth layer yet
11 May ~11:15	Drizzle schema + seed endpoint pushed (commits <code>4e455ee7</code> , <code>86e2ddae</code>)	DB tables created, test enrollment seeded
11 May ~11:30	First login attempt at <code>/method/login</code>	HTTP 500 — <code>METHOD_SESSION_SECRET</code> not set on Vercel
11 May ~11:45	<code>METHOD_SESSION_SECRET</code> added to Vercel env vars, redeploy triggered	Redeployment starts
11 May ~11:50	Magic link clicked during redeploy transition	Old deployment consumed token (marked <code>usedAt</code>) but crashed before setting session cookie. Token burned.
11 May ~12:00	Second magic link requested + clicked	Session cookie set successfully. Redirect to <code>/method</code> → <code>/method/dashboard</code>
11 May ~12:00	<code>ERR_TOO_MANY_REDIRECTS</code> on all <code>/method/*</code> pages	Layout pathname detection broken: always defaulted to <code>"/method"</code>
11 May ~12:15	Support email fix committed (<code>cc603dd0</code>)	<code>sarah@roadmancycling.com</code> across all Method pages
11 May 13:32	Middleware v1 deployed (<code>52939056</code>)	Set <code>x-pathname</code> on <code>RESPONSE</code> headers — wrong target. Still looping.
11 May 12:35 (UTC)	Middleware v2 + layout fix deployed (<code>205d183a</code>)	Set <code>x-pathname</code> on <code>REQUEST</code> headers via <code>NextResponse.next({ request })</code> . Layout fallback chain added.

Root Cause

The Method layout (`src/app/(method)/method/layout.tsx`) determines the current page by reading an `x-pathname` request header. Without middleware to set this header, it always fell back to `"/method"`. The layout contains redirect logic: if the user has an active session and the pathname is `"/method"`, redirect to `/method/dashboard`. Since the pathname was always `"/method"` regardless of the actual

URL, visiting `/method/dashboard` triggered another redirect to `/method/dashboard` — an infinite loop.

The first middleware fix (commit 52939056) set the header on the response object using `response.headers.set()`. However, Next.js server components read `REQUEST` headers via the `headers()` API, not response headers. The header was never visible to the layout.

Resolution

Commit 205d183a fixes both issues:

- 1. Middleware (`src/middleware.ts`):** Uses `NextResponse.next({ request: { headers } })` to inject `x-pathname` into the request headers, which is the documented Next.js pattern for forwarding request metadata to server components.
- 2. Layout (`src/app/(method)/method/layout.tsx`):** Added `resolvePathname()` function that checks `x-pathname`, `x-invoke-path`, `x-forwarded-url`, `x-url`, and `x-original-url` before falling back to `"/method"`. This prevents silent pathname misresolution even if middleware fails.

Relevant URLs

Page	URL	Status
Login	https://roadmancycling.com/method/login	Should resolve after deploy
Dashboard	https://roadmancycling.com/method/dashboard	Requires active session
Sales page	https://roadmancycling.com/method	Public
Check email	https://roadmancycling.com/method/login/check-email	Public (post-login interstitial)
Account	https://roadmancycling.com/method/account	Requires active session
Magic link verify	https://roadmancycling.com/api/method/login/verify?token=...	Single-use, 15-min TTL

Commits

Hash	Timestamp	Description
205d183a	11 May 12:35 UTC	fix: middleware sets request headers + resilient pathname resolution
52939056	11 May 13:32 BST	fix: add middleware to set <code>x-pathname</code> header (initial, incorrect)
cc603dd0	11 May 12:13 UTC	fix: update Method support email to sarah@roadmancycling.com
86e2ddae	11 May 12:54 BST	feat: add Method schema to drizzle config + dotenv loader
4e455ee7	11 May 12:25 BST	Add temporary Method seed endpoint for testing